

Physical Education

Year 5

Cambridge Primary

Student Manual





Physical Education

Year 5 • Student Manual

A student book for Upper Primary, written for pupils of about nine to ten years old. Year 1 played in the open meadow. Year 2 played on a marked court. Year 3 stepped onto a measured cinder track. This year the six of you walk up to the long field, where the grass is mown, the strips are pegged out in white rope, and there is a pavilion to sit on when it is your turn to watch.

Six places, one field: the Practice Strip, the Pavilion Steps, the Orchard, the Match Ground, the Equipment Barn and the Beacon Path. You will take four jobs in turn, and one of them is new this year.

A movement is not one thing. It is several things joined up, and the joins are where the work is.

Physical Education • Year 5

Student Manual. First edition, 2026.

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Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in a magenta **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Square codes. Both square codes in this book were scanned, and both addresses were opened and read, when this edition went to press. An adult holds the device and opens the page. Pages outside Prime School's control may move or close, and Prime School is not responsible for their content.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body in order to succeed. Teachers adapt distances, heights and timings freely: the objective is control, not size or speed.

Interior 8.5 × 11 in. British English throughout. Measurements are metric, times are on the 24 hour clock, and money is in euros. Printed in Portugal on paper from responsibly managed forests.

Come out to the long field

You already know how to run, jump, land, throw, catch and travel. You have been doing all of it since Year 1, and by now you do most of it without thinking.

This year we are going to make you think about it, once, on purpose, and then let you stop thinking about it again.

Here is the idea the whole book turns on. **A movement is not one thing.** A throw is a stand, then a reach, then a release, then a finish. A jump is a run up, then a take off, then a flight, then a landing. Every one of those parts can be practised on its own, and every place where two parts meet is a **join**.

Most pupils in Year 5 are already reasonably good at the parts. Almost nobody is good at the joins. That is where this book spends its time.



The long field before anybody arrives. Mown grass, one strip pegged out in white rope, the pavilion waiting with its three steps, the stone wall and the orchard beyond. Look at the rope: nearly everything in this book happens because somebody decided where a line should go.

What is different about Year 5

In Year 3 the useful answer was *I can jump*. This year it sounds more like this:

I can land my jump without a wobble, I can go straight from the landing into a turn without stopping, I can do the whole thing slowly if you ask me to, and if somebody

steps into my space halfway through I can change it without falling over.

Same jump. Far more control, and much more useful.

How the book is built

Six places on and around the long field, one for each unit. Each one is there for a reason.

THE LONG FIELD • SIX PLACES, ONE PER UNIT

- 1 **The Practice Strip.** Practising until a skill changes, joining skills into sequences, controlling speed, level and path, and adapting when the task or the friends around you change.
- 2 **The Pavilion Steps.** Where you sit and watch. Words for what a body actually did, and how to judge whether it worked.
- 3 **The Orchard.** Long grass and no lines at all. Movement nobody showed you, and movement that says something.
- 4 **The Match Ground.** Rope and teams. Your job, everybody else's job, and taking a turn at leading.
- 5 **The Equipment Barn.** Sharing a space and a set of equipment safely, fair play, and how to ask for help well.
- 6 **The Beacon Path.** The long climb behind the orchard. What is happening inside you while you move, and what a working body needs.

This book is place one, the Practice Strip. The other five follow in the complete edition.

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A dash means that unit is mapped and waiting: this edition carries Unit 1 only.

Your year on the long field

Three terms, and each one finishes with a whole day on the field. You will meet every one of these days having already practised the parts it is made of, which is the point of working the way this book works.

TERM 1 ENDS Athletics Day December 2026 ● Sprint ● Relays ● Standing long jump ● Target throw ● Obstacle race	TERM 2 ENDS Football Day March 2026 ● Dribbling in and out of the cones race ● Passing accuracy game ● Penalty shootout ● Full game	TERM 3 ENDS Multi-sports Day June 2026 ● Bowling ● Sack racing ● Bean bag throw ● Water pong
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Where this unit takes you

Read the three cards again and find the events this unit prepares you for. There are more of them than you would expect from one term.

THE DAY	WHAT UNIT 1 GIVES YOU FOR IT
Athletics Day, term 1	The standing long jump and the target throw are the two skills taken apart in topics 1.1 and 1.2. The obstacle race is topic 1.3: speed, level and path, changed on purpose.
Football Day, term 2	Dribbling in and out of the cones is the path dial from topic 1.3. The full game is topic 1.4, where somebody else moves before you do.
Multi-sports Day, term 3	Bowling and the bean bag throw are the phases and joins of topic 1.1 again, on a different skill. Sack racing is a movement you have never practised, which is exactly what topic 1.3 is for.

Every one of those days rewards the same habit: choose one part, change it on purpose, and check with a watcher whether the whole thing got better.

Meet the six

The same six as last year, a year older, and all six of them turn up all through this book, usually getting something slightly wrong first.

Pip

Red squirrel, sage vest and navy shorts. First to try anything, and he will try it before the instruction has finished. He is finding out this year that his quickest attempt and his best attempt are not the same attempt.

Bramble

Badger, slate tracksuit, stopwatch on a chain. Strong and steady and he never rushes. He is learning the difference between surviving a landing and controlling one.

Sorrel

Brown hare, olive vest. The fastest of all of them by some distance. This year she finds out that speed is one dynamic among several, and that it is not always the one the task is asking for.

Tuft

Hedgehog, terracotta vest. The smallest and the most careful, and he reads a space before he moves into it. His job this year is harder than it sounds: changing a movement on purpose instead of only repeating it.

Rowan

Otter, hedge-green vest. The organiser. Give him four jobs and six friends and everybody ends up busy. He is learning to take a job himself rather than hand them all out.

Willow

Barn owl. The watcher. She sits up on the pavilion rail because from there she can see the whole shape of a movement instead of just the end of it. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you *saw* rather than whether you liked it.

None of the six is better than the others. Each is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap jobs.



Willow, working. She is the one sitting still, and she is the busiest of the six. Look at where she is looking: out at the mover, not down at her notebook. A watcher who writes while the movement is happening misses the movement.

When you see a slate panel headed **Willow's own notes**, that is Willow writing down exactly what one body did. Copy the way she says it, not only what she says.

Four jobs, and you will do all four

Almost every task in this book needs three or four of you, because you cannot watch yourself move. Three of these jobs you already know from Year 3. The fourth is new.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or quietly change it halfway through
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, start the watch early, or round the number kindly
Watcher	Look at one part only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all
Caller	Change the task while it is running, out loud, once	Change it twice, or change it to something unsafe

The Caller is the new one, and it is the whole reason Unit 1 has a fourth topic. A movement you can only do when nothing changes is not yet under your control.

Where you stand matters as much as which job you hold. Here are all four of them at once, on one strip.



The four jobs, all on one strip. Pip is the mover. Bramble is at the far end with the stopwatch, watching Pip rather than the watch. Rowan is off the strip halfway along with an arm up, because that is where a call can be heard in time. And Willow is the only one off the grass and above it, because the shape of a whole movement is only visible from up there.

Swap jobs every round. The watcher's job is the one most of you are worst at, and it is the one that makes you better at the other three.

How to use this book

Every place on the field is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are on a page.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Come out to the field	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On this ground you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from an earlier year that you are about to need again.
Learn	The drawing and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch one done well	One attempt taken slowly, with a reason given for each part.
Try it the other way	A second method, because one method is a trick rather than a skill.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What Willow actually wrote down. A model for your own notes.
Stay safe	Magenta. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
What you need on the field	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about waiting.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Field challenge	Harder. Expect to need three attempts.
The long field games	The project at the end of the place.
How did it go?	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.
Words we used	Every new word, with its meaning.

Phase strips

The drawing this book uses most is a **phase strip**: a movement cut into its parts, in order, left to right. Here is one, so that you have seen a phase strip before the first one turns up in a lesson.

PHASE STRIP · A STANDING JUMP, AS AN EXAMPLE

1
Sink
knees bend, arms swing
back behind you

2
Drive
legs straighten hard,
arms swing forward and
up

3
Flight
both feet off the grass,
body long

4
Land
both feet together,
knees bend again, and
you stop still

Four parts, three joins. You have been doing all four since Year 1. What you have probably never done is choose one of them and work on it by itself.

Look at the narrow cream gaps between the blocks. **Those gaps are the joins**, and they are the thing you are working on. A pupil who can do all four blocks and none of the gaps has four movements. A pupil who can do the gaps as well has one.

Plan panels and elevations

A **plan panel** is the field seen from directly above, the way Willow sees it from the pavilion rail. An **elevation** is the same ground seen from the side, which is the only way to show height. The marks always mean the same thing, in every unit:

MARK	MEANS
a solid white rope line	a boundary you may not cross
a dashed white line	the path a body travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a white cross	a cone, a marker or a peg
a filled dark circle	a body, at one moment
the ticks down the left edge	metres, counted

Writing in this book

You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and

that is the entire point of the book.

The square codes

Two pages carry a small square code. Each one opens a page that offers your teacher more routes and more games than this book has room for. **An adult holds the device and opens the page.** There is nothing in this book you cannot finish without one.

Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each place on the field tells you what to fetch.

Your field kit

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- eight cones, or eight of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- two skipping ropes
- one ball that bounces, and one that does not
- a measuring tape, or a metre stick
- a notebook, or something firm to write on while standing up
- a pencil, because half of this book gets written in
- five other people, which is the most important item on the list



Your kit, laid out. Nothing here needs a screen. Count it against the list above: shoes, a watch, five cones, a rope, a ball, a folded cloth, a notebook and a pencil. The notebook does more work in this unit than the ball does.

Field rules

- 1 Walk onto the field. Everybody walks on, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look before you move. Then look again if somebody else is already moving.

- 3 One mover at a time inside a roped strip, unless the task says otherwise.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind. A kind number is a useless number, and Unit 1 explains why.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 The Caller changes the task once, clearly, and never to anything unsafe.
- 7 Put the equipment back in the barn, at the end, without being asked.
- 8 Stop the moment you hear "stop". Not after this one. Now.
- 9 An adult holds the device for any square code.

STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check three things and say them out loud:

The grass. Dry enough, clear, nothing to trip on and nothing hidden in it.

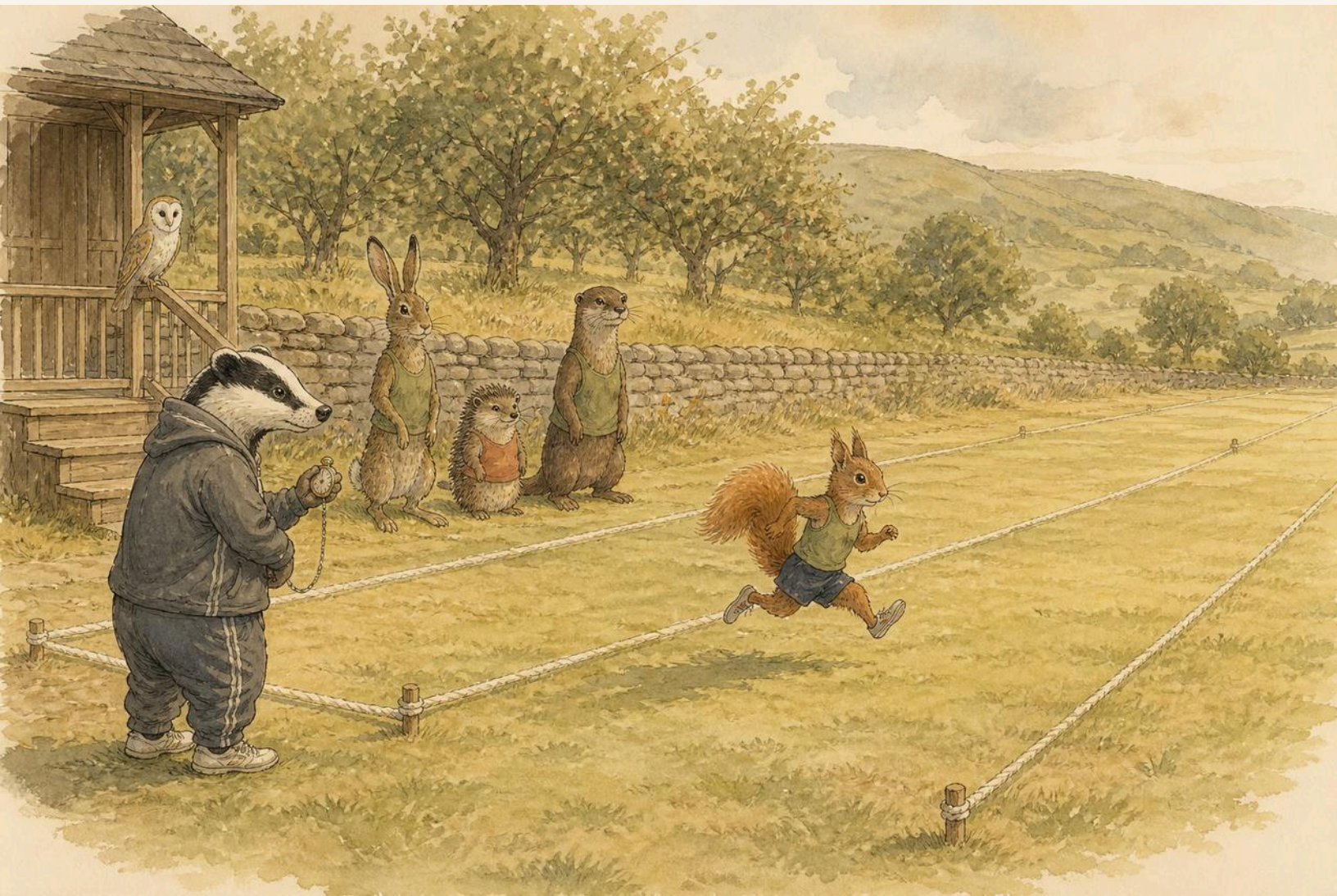
The edges. Nothing hard within two paces of any rope you might run past.

The apparatus. Every bench, mat and piece of equipment carried out and tested by an adult, not by you.

If any of the three is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

1 Moving well

A movement is several things joined up. This unit takes one apart, makes each part better, and then puts it back together so the joins do not show.



✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

1.1

practise one part of a skill on purpose, and say what changed

1.2

join three or four skills into a sequence with no stop at the joins

1.3

perform the same skill at different speeds, levels and paths, deliberately

1.4

keep that control when the task changes and when other people move first

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Think of one thing your body does well. Catching a ball. Skipping. Running round a bend without slowing down.

Now the harder question. **Which part of it are you good at?**

Almost nobody can answer that, because a movement you can already do feels like one single thing. It is not. Every movement you have is made of parts, and you got good at it without ever seeing them.

On this ground you are going to see them.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Practise that changes a skill

■ WHAT YOU NEED ON THE FIELD

One ball each, a wall you are allowed to throw at, five cones, a stopwatch, a notebook and a pencil. Work in fours.

✦ WARM UP

Jog anywhere in the space for ninety seconds, changing direction every time you meet somebody, without touching anybody. Then swing each arm forward five times and backward five times, and rise onto your toes ten times.

Now stand still. You are warm, your shoulders are loose and your ankles are awake. Cold practice is wasted practice.



Fifteen throws at the stone wall, and Willow counting. She is not waiting her turn: counting is a job, and on this ground it is the job that tells the thrower whether anything changed.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is throwing a ball at a wall. He throws it thirty times, which takes him about four minutes, and he is pleased with himself.

Willow has been watching from the pavilion rail with her notebook. She says: "That was one throw, thirty times."

Pip says that is the same as thirty throws.

It is not, and the difference between those two sentences is what this whole topic is about.

☞ DO YOU REMEMBER?

*In Year 3 you learned that a **smooth** movement has no wasted wobble, no extra step and no arm shooting out to save it. You are going to need that word again in about a minute.*

► Learn

Doing a movement thirty times is not practising it. It is **repeating** it.

Practice means repeating a movement *with one part you are trying to change*. Without that part, you are keeping fit, which is fine, but nothing gets better.

Three things make a practice work, and if any one is missing the other two are wasted.

IT MUST HAVE	WHICH MEANS
One part to change	Not "throw better". "Get my elbow above my shoulder before the ball leaves my hand."
A way to tell	A watcher looking at that one part, or a number from the timer. Not a feeling.
Enough goes	Three attempts tell you nothing at all. Fifteen start to tell you something.

So before you can practise a skill, you have to be able to see its parts. Here is an overarm throw, taken apart.

PHASE STRIP 1.1 • THE OVERARM THROW

1 Stand side on to the wall, feet apart, weight on the back foot, ball in your throwing hand	2 Reach throwing arm back and high, elbow above the shoulder, other arm pointing at the target	3 Release weight moves onto the front foot, arm comes through fast, the ball leaves high	4 Finish throwing arm carries on down and across the body, and you stay on your feet
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Four parts, and three joins: 1 into 2, 2 into 3, and 3 into 4. Pip has all four parts. What he has not got is the join from 2 into 3, which is why the ball arrives low.

Now read the phase strip again and notice something. **You cannot practise a throw.** A throw is too big to practise. You can only practise **one phase, or one join**, and then check whether the whole throw changed.

That is why Willow was right. Pip repeated the whole throw thirty times, so none of the parts got any attention and none of them changed.

■ WATCH ONE DONE WELL

Tuft practises the join from 2 into 3. He does not throw at all for the first few goes.

- 1 He stands side on, gets to the end of phase 2, and **stops there**, holding it, with his elbow above his shoulder. Willow checks the elbow and says yes or no. Six times.
- 2 Then he does phases 2 and 3 together, slowly, at about half speed, so the weight moves onto the front foot *before* the arm comes through. Six times.

- 3 Only then does he throw properly, at full speed, fifteen times, while Willow watches the elbow and nothing else and calls out "above" or "below".

His first fifteen throws that morning: nine of them low. His last fifteen: three of them low.

Notice what he changed. He did not throw harder and he did not throw more. He took one join out, worked on it slowly, and put it back.

* THE WATCHER'S NOTES

Pip, throws 1 to 10. Elbow below the shoulder every time. Ball hits the wall low, about knee height. Front foot never moves.

Pip, throws 21 to 30. Elbow below the shoulder every time. Ball hits low every time. Front foot never moves.

Nothing changed between throw 1 and throw 30.

Look at what Willow wrote and, more importantly, at what she did not write. She did not write "Pip needs to try harder", and she did not write "not very good". She wrote **what she saw**, in the same words each time, so the two sets can be compared.

That is the whole job. A watcher who says "good" has given the mover nothing to work with.

• Your turn

Work in fours: mover, timer, watcher, and one to fetch the ball. Swap after every round so that everybody does all four jobs.

- 1 Choose **one phase or one join** from the strip above. Write it in the box, in the same style Willow uses: what a body part does, not how well.

THE ONE PART I AM CHANGING

- 2 Throw fifteen times while your watcher looks at that one part only, and nothing else. Tally what the watcher calls.

ROUND	PART THE WATCHER IS LOOKING AT	YES	NO
First fifteen	_____	_____	_____
After you have worked on it	_____	_____	_____

- 3 Now take the part out and work on it slowly, the way Tuft did. Do it six times at half speed, holding the position if you can. Then throw fifteen more times.
- 4 Write the two numbers side by side and finish this sentence honestly.

WHAT CHANGED, AND HOW I KNOW

- 5 One more, and it is the difficult one. Your watcher now looks at the **whole throw** and says whether the ball is arriving higher. If your one part got better and the whole throw did not change at all, that is a real and interesting result. Write it down rather than hiding it.

DID THE WHOLE THROW CHANGE?

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The NHS recommends that children and young people aged 5 to 18 "aim for an average of at least 60 minutes of moderate or vigorous intensity physical activity a day across the week".

Read the next part of the same guidance, though, because it is the part that belongs in this unit. It asks for "a variety of types and intensities of physical activity across the week to **develop movement skills**, muscles and bones".

Not just more minutes. A variety of them. Which is precisely what topic 1.3 is about.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Try the same three step method on a skill nobody has taken apart for you: a chest pass, an underarm serve, or a standing jump.

Write your own phase strip for it first, on paper, before you move. Four boxes and three joins. If you cannot name the parts, you cannot practise them, and finding that out is useful in itself.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Joining skills into a sequence

■ WHAT YOU NEED ON THE FIELD

One low bench, two mats, six cones, a stopwatch and a pencil. Work in fours. An adult sets out the bench and the mats.

✦ WARM UP

Travel across the space and back four times, using a different way each time: running, side steps, long slow strides, and skipping. Then stand on one foot for ten seconds, and the other foot for ten seconds.



One sequence, three friends, three phases. Read the picture left to right: Sorrel finishing her run, Tuft at the top of the jump with both arms level, and Rowan holding the balance on one foot. Now look at the two gaps between them. Those are the joins.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Bramble has been given three skills to join: a run, a jump onto and off a low bench, and a still balance on one foot at the end.

He can do all three. He is easily the best in the class at the jump.

What he actually does is this: run, **stop**, get himself sorted out, jump, **stop**, get his balance ready, balance. Rowan times it at nine seconds. Bramble says he did all three, and he is right.

Willow writes down: *three movements, two stops.*

► Learn

A **sequence** is two or more skills performed one after another with no stop in between. The skills are not the hard part. **The joins are the hard part**, and a sequence is judged on them.

Here is Bramble's sequence as a phase strip. The cream gaps are the joins.

PHASE STRIP 1.2 • RUN, JUMP, BALANCE

1 Run five or six strides, building up, eyes on the bench	2 Jump up onto the bench, along it, and off the end, landing on two feet	3 Balance straight out of the landing onto one foot, arms out, held for three seconds
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Two joins. Join 1 into 2 is where Bramble stops to get himself sorted out. Join 2 into 3 is where almost everybody stops, because a landing feels like an ending.

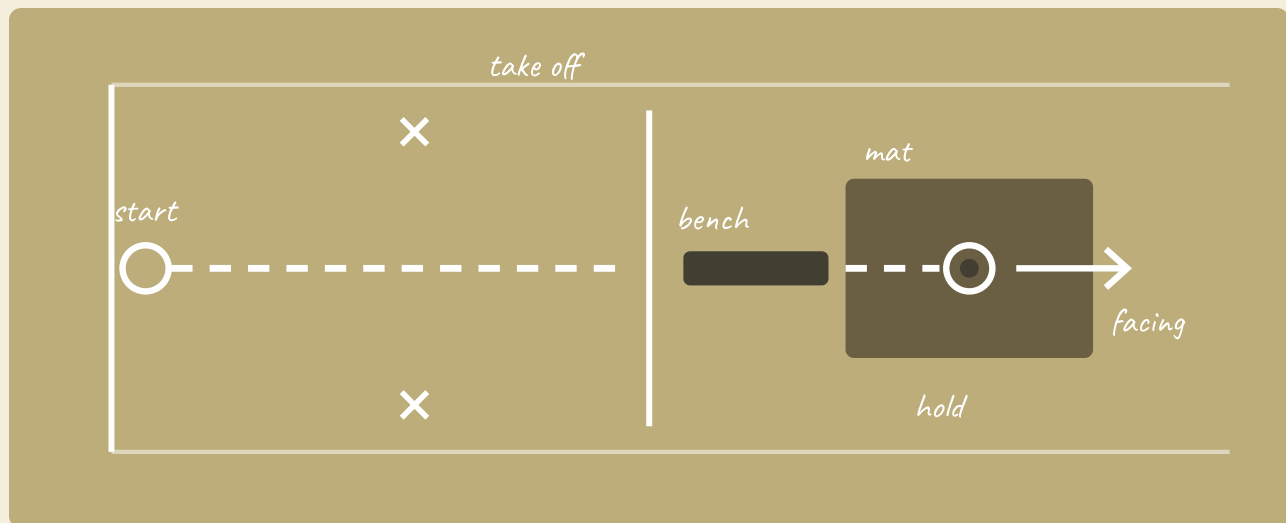
Two things make a join work, and they are both about **the end of the first skill** rather than the start of the second one.

TO JOIN TWO SKILLS	YOU HAVE TO
Finish the first one facing the right way	A landing that faces away from the bench cannot become a balance without a shuffle. Decide where you will be pointing before you start.
Finish the first one at the right speed	You cannot go from a full sprint straight into a still balance. Take the speed off during the last two strides of the run, not after it.

That second one surprises people. A join is usually fixed **earlier** than where it goes wrong. Bramble's stop at join 2 into 3 is actually caused by how fast he is still travelling at the end of phase 1.

Here is the same sequence seen from above, so you can see where the facing matters.

PLAN 1.2 • THE SAME SEQUENCE, SEEN FROM ABOVE



Look at the arrow at the far end. The balance is held facing the same way the run was travelling. Nothing in the sequence turns round, which is why nothing in it needs a shuffle.

■ WATCH ONE DONE WELL

Bramble fixes join 2 into 3, by changing phase 1.

- 1 First he tries the obvious thing: land, then balance faster. It does not work. He is still travelling forwards when he lands, so he has to put the second foot down to stop.
- 2 Rowan suggests he take two strides off the run up. Bramble hates this, because it makes the jump smaller.
- 3 He tries it anyway. The jump is smaller. The landing is slower. The balance comes straight out of it with no second foot.

Timed: nine seconds before, five and a half seconds after, and no stops.

The lesson is the awkward one. To fix the last join, he had to make the part he was proudest of smaller.

● **Your turn**

Work in fours and swap jobs each round.

- 1 Build your own three part sequence from these: a travel, something onto or over the bench, a turn, a still balance, a roll along a mat. Write your three parts in order.

MY SEQUENCE

1 _____	2 _____	3 _____
----------------	----------------	----------------

And now name your two joins: 1 into 2, and 2 into 3.

- 2 Perform it three times. Your timer times the whole thing, and your watcher counts **only the stops**.

ATTEMPT	TIME IN SECONDS	STOPS THE WATCHER COUNTED
First	_____	_____
Second	_____	_____
Third	_____	_____

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Ground rule 4 said the timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind. Here is why it matters, now that you are using a stopwatch properly for the first time.

A timer who quietly takes a tenth of a second off to be nice has not been kind: they have thrown away the only evidence the mover had that their practice worked. Numbers are how you find out whether anything changed. **A kind number is a useless number.**

- 3 Choose **the worse of your two joins** and write down what actually happens there. Not "it goes wrong": what your body does.

WHAT HAPPENS AT MY WORSE JOIN

- 4 Now change something **before** it, the way Bramble did, and run the sequence three more times.

AFTER THE CHANGE	TIME IN SECONDS	STOPS
First	_____	_____
Second	_____	_____
Third	_____	_____

- 5 Draw your sequence as a plan, seen from above, in the box. Mark the start ring, the route as a dashed line, the equipment as crosses, and put an arrow at the end to show which way you are facing.

MY SEQUENCE, SEEN FROM ABOVE

STAY SAFE

The bench and the mats are set out and tested by an adult, not by you. Check three things out loud before your first attempt:

Landing area. A mat where you land, flat, with no gap between two mats.

Run up. Clear, and nobody crossing it. One mover at a time.

Bench. Both feet of the bench on the floor, and it does not rock when you push it.

If the sequence has a roll in it, an adult watches every attempt.

■ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE



Sixty second challenges. Short movement challenges you repeat and measure against your own last attempt, which is exactly the method in topic 1.1 applied to a whole class at once. Your teacher can pick one that fits the space you have.

AN ADULT HOLDS THE DEVICE AND OPENS THE PAGE

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Four parts, two seconds faster, no stops.

Add a fourth skill to your sequence, so it has three joins instead of two. Then get the whole thing two seconds faster than your best three part time, with the watcher still counting zero stops.

You are allowed to make any single part smaller in order to do it. Most people have to.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Control, fluency and variety

■ WHAT YOU NEED ON THE FIELD

Six cones, one ball, a stopwatch, a measuring tape or metre stick, and a pencil. Work in fours.

◆ WARM UP

Travel from one side of the space to the other and back, three times: once as quickly as you safely can, once as slowly as you possibly can without stopping, and once staying as low as you can the whole way. The slow one is the hardest. Notice that.



Sorrel travelling the same distance twice, two different ways. On the left she is upright and fast. On the right she is low and slow, curving round the cone. Neither is wrong. The question this topic asks is whether you can choose.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel is the fastest in the class. The task is to travel twelve metres in a curved path, slowly and low.

She does it fast and upright, because that is what her body does. Rowan asks her to do it again, slowly. She does it slightly less fast and slightly less upright.

She is not being difficult. She genuinely cannot find slow, because she has never practised it. Fast is the only setting she has.

► Learn

Control means your body does what you decided it would do. **Fluency** means it does it without stopping or wobbling. **Variety** means you can decide differently next time.

You need all three, and the third one is the one most people are missing. A pupil with one setting has a trick. A pupil with four settings has a skill.

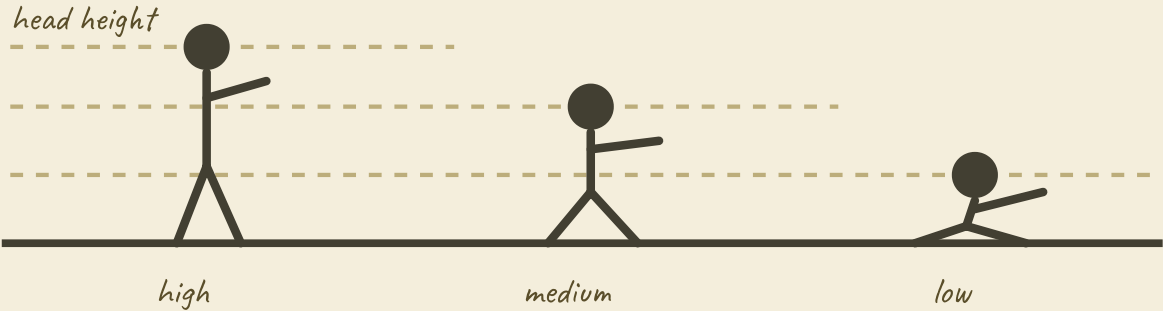
There are three dials you can turn on almost any movement, and only three.

DIAL	SETTINGS	A QUESTION THAT FINDS IT
Speed	fast, slow, and speeding up or slowing down as you go	Could you do that at half the speed and still make it look deliberate?

DIAL	SETTINGS	A QUESTION THAT FINDS IT
Level	high, medium, low	Could you do that with your knees bent the whole way?
Path	straight, curved, zigzag	Could you get there without travelling in a straight line?

Turn one dial and you have a new version of the same skill. Turn two and it barely looks like the same skill at all, which is the point.

ELEVATION 1.3 • THE LEVEL DIAL, SEEN FROM THE SIDE



Follow the dashed lines across. Three bodies, one ground line, three different head heights. Low is not crouching at the end: it is staying down for the whole distance, which is far harder work than it looks.

🕒 DO YOU REMEMBER?

*In Year 3 you did the same movement fast, slow, high and low. This year there is a fourth dial setting inside speed: **changing speed on purpose while you travel**, which is what a real game asks for.*

⇌ TRY IT THE OTHER WAY

Sorrel cannot find slow by being told to go slower. So try the other way in: **give the movement something to be slow for.**

Method one, the one that does not work. "Sorrel, do it slowly." She goes slightly less fast.

Method two. Put a cone every two metres along the twelve metre curve, and give her a rule: **you must touch the ground beside each cone with one hand as you pass it.** Do not mention speed at all.

She now travels the twelve metres low and slowly, because the task cannot be done any other way. Then Rowan takes the cones away and asks her to do exactly what she just did. This time she can find it.

The principle is worth keeping: if a pupil cannot find a dial setting by being told, **change the task so that the setting is the only way to finish it.**

• Your turn

- 1 Choose one way of travelling: running, side stepping, skipping, or a bounce and catch as you go. Write it down. This is your skill for the whole task.

MY SKILL

- 2 Perform it over twelve metres four times, turning one dial each time. Your timer times each one and your watcher writes down one thing they actually saw.

VERSION	TIME IN SECONDS	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW
As you normally do it	_____	_____
Slow, and deliberate	_____	_____
Low, the whole way	_____	_____

VERSION	TIME IN SECONDS	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW
Curved path, not straight		

3 Draw the four versions as four plans seen from above. Same skill in each box, so the only thing that changes between them is the dial.

NORMAL	SLOW
LOW	CURVED

4 Which version was hardest? It is almost never the fast one. Write which, and why you think so.

HARDEST VERSION, AND WHY

5 Now the useful question, and it is the one the whole unit has been building to. Think of a moment in a real game where **each** of your four versions would be the right choice.

VERSION	A MOMENT WHEN THIS IS THE RIGHT CHOICE
Normal	
Slow	

VERSION

A MOMENT WHEN THIS IS THE RIGHT CHOICE

Low

Curved

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

One lap of a standard outdoor athletics track is **400 metres**, run in a marked lane. World Athletics describes the 400 metres as an event "in which athletes complete one lap of a standard outdoor 400m athletics track while running in a designated lane".

So the twelve metres you have just travelled four different ways is about one thirty third of a single lap. Do the arithmetic the other way round and it is worth knowing: at four versions per twelve metres, one lap would give you well over a hundred goes at turning a dial.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Turn **two** dials at once: slow *and* curved, or low *and* speeding up as you go.

Then hand your two dial version to somebody who did not see you plan it, and ask them to name which two you turned. If they cannot tell, you have not turned them far enough to count.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Reading the field and the friends on it

■ WHAT YOU NEED ON THE FIELD

Eight cones, two balls, bibs or bands in two colours, and a pencil. Work in a group of five or six, with one Caller.

✦ WARM UP

In pairs, one leads and one follows, half a pace behind, copying every change of direction. Ninety seconds, then swap. The leader is not trying to lose the follower.



A call has just been made, and everybody is adjusting. Rowan is on the pavilion step with one arm up: that is the Caller. Then look at the four on the grass. Not one of them is watching a ball. They are all watching each other.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan sets up a four a side game on the match ground. It works well for about two minutes.

Then he calls out: "**Only side steps.**"

Pip keeps running, because he did not hear it. Bramble hears it, stops completely, thinks, and then starts side stepping. Tuft changes to side steps without stopping, and he is the only one who does. Sorrel keeps playing exactly as before, at speed, and scores.

One of those five responses is the skill this topic teaches. It is not the one who scored.

► Learn

Everything so far has happened on a surface where nothing changed. Real activity is not like that. Something always changes: the rule, the space, the equipment, or what another person decides to do half a second before you do.

Adapting means changing what your body is doing, while it is doing it, without stopping.

That is why this unit has a fourth job.

JOB IN THIS TOPIC

Caller Changes one thing, out loud, once, while the activity is running. Then watches what happens.

Three things change in an activity, and a good Caller only ever changes one at a time.

WHAT CHANGES AN EXAMPLE A CALLER CAN CALL

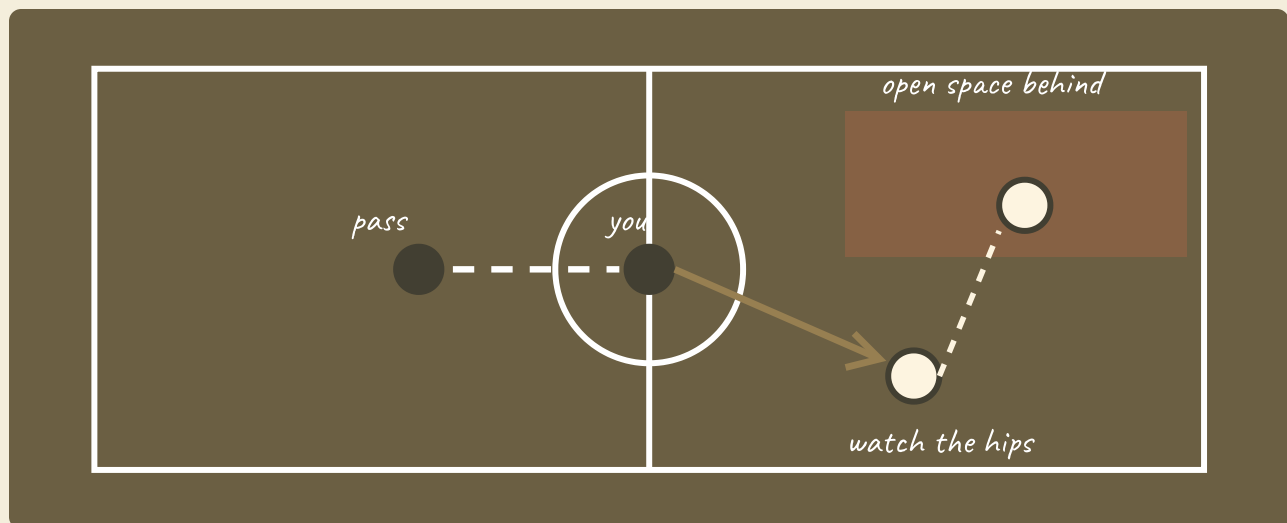
The rule "Only side steps." "Three passes before a shot." "Left hand only."

The space "That third of the match ground is closed." "Everybody inside the arc."

The people "Swap one player between teams." "Bramble plays for both sides."

And there is a fourth thing that changes constantly with nobody calling it at all: **what the person opposite you does**. Reading that is the hardest part of Year 5 Physical Education, and it cannot be taught from a page. What a page can do is tell you where to look.

PLAN 1.4 • WHERE TO LOOK, AND WHEN



Look at the ochre arrow, not the dashed one. You are the dark circle in the middle. The player you are marking is the pale circle nearest you. Watch their hips, because hips cannot lie about which way somebody is about to go, and feet and eyes both can. The shaded block is the space that opens if they turn.

■ WATCH ONE DONE WELL

Tuft adapts without stopping, and here is what he actually did.

Rowan calls "only side steps" while Tuft is mid stride.

- 1 He does not stop. He finishes the stride he is already in, because stopping in the middle of a stride is how you fall over.
- 2 He turns his shoulders square to the direction he was travelling, which is the one change that makes a side step possible.
- 3 He takes the next step sideways, slowly, and only gets quicker once the second sideways step has landed.

Three quarters of a second, no stop, and he was slow for about two seconds afterwards. Being slow for two seconds is the price, and it is a much smaller price than stopping.

Bramble did the same three things. He just did them in the wrong order, and stopping was how he bought himself the time to think.

● Your turn

Play a small game of your own choosing, four a side, with one Caller. The Caller changes **one** thing every ninety seconds and writes down what happened.

- 1 Choose your activity and write down what it is and the one rule that matters most in it.

OUR ACTIVITY, AND ITS MOST IMPORTANT RULE

- 2 The Caller fills this in as the game runs. Everybody else fills it in afterwards, from memory, and then you compare.

CALL	WHAT THE CALLER CHANGED	WHO KEPT MOVING	WHO STOPPED FIRST
First	_____	_____	_____

CALL	WHAT THE CALLER CHANGED	WHO KEPT MOVING	WHO STOPPED FIRST
Second	_____	_____	_____

Third _____

- 3 Take a turn as the Caller yourself. Write the call you made, and then be honest about whether it was a good one. A good call changes one thing, is safe, and can be understood in three words.

MY CALL, AND WHETHER IT WAS A GOOD ONE

- 4 Now choose your own activity for the last ten minutes of the lesson, and justify the choice. This is the part of the topic your teacher is looking at most closely.

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER
----------	-------------

What did you choose?

Which of your four dial settings does it need most?

Which of the four jobs are you weakest at, and will this activity make you use it?

- 5 Last one. Write down one thing somebody else did that you are going to copy. Name them, and say what they did rather than that they were good at it.

WHAT I AM GOING TO COPY, AND FROM WHOM

■ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE



Choose your own, from an A to Z. A list of sports and activities from the NHS, with games you can vary and ways to be active that do not look like sport at all. Task 4 above asks you to choose an activity for yourself and say why. This is where to look if you cannot think of one.

AN ADULT HOLDS THE DEVICE AND OPENS THE PAGE

■ STAY SAFE

A change of rule changes the risk as well as the game. Before any call, the Caller checks two things:

Is it safe at speed? "Eyes closed" and "backwards only" are not calls. Anything that stops a pupil seeing where they are going is never called.

Does everybody know? A call nobody heard is worse than no call at all, because half the group is now playing a different game from the other half. Call it loudly, once, and check that heads come up.

If two pupils are moving fast towards the same space, the call is "stop", and everybody stops.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

The silent call.

Play the same game again, but the Caller may not speak. They change the space instead: move one cone, close one area, or put a bib on the floor. Nobody is told what the change means.

The task for everybody else is to work out what changed, adapt, and keep playing. Expect it to go wrong for about twenty seconds. That twenty seconds is the most useful part of this unit.

The long field games

Everything on this ground, in one afternoon, in rotating roles.



The long field games, and notice who is sitting down. Two friends working on the strip, three on the pavilion steps with notebooks and the watch, one standing with an arm up. On this afternoon four of the six jobs do not involve moving at all, and the book counts them equally.

You are going to run your own meet, in groups of six, and every pupil holds every job at least once.

What you are making

Not a competition. A **meet**: four stations around the ground, a rotation, and a record of what each mover changed between their first attempt and their last.

The only score that gets written down is each mover against their own first attempt. There is no winner, and this is not a softening of the task. Comparing two pupils tells you nothing you can act on. Comparing one pupil with themselves half an hour ago tells them exactly what to do next.

The four stations

- 1 **The practice station** (topic 1.1). One skill, one phase or join chosen, fifteen attempts, a tally before and after. The watcher looks at one part only.

- 2 **The sequence station** (topic 1.2). A three or four part sequence, timed, with the watcher counting stops rather than judging quality.
- 3 **The dial station** (topic 1.3). One skill, performed four ways, and the mover has to say which dial they turned before they go.
- 4 **The caller station** (topic 1.4). A small game with a Caller changing one thing every ninety seconds.



Setting up, before anybody competes. Six friends and five loads: a bench between two of them, an armful of cones, a rope, a rolled mat, and Willow carrying nothing at all because her job starts later. Count the jobs in this picture. There are more of them than there are stations.

How to run it

- 1 Six pupils, four stations. At each station two people are moving and the rest are timing, watching and calling. Twelve minutes per station.
- 2 Before you start, write the rotation down so that every pupil holds all four jobs across the afternoon. Rowan is good at this. So are you, with a pencil.
- 3 Every mover gets a record sheet, and the watcher fills it in. Not the mover.
- 4 After every station, the watcher reads out what they wrote, in their own words, to the mover. Thirty seconds each. This is the part everybody wants to skip and it is the part that does the work.
- 5 At the end, each pupil writes one sentence: what changed today, and how they know.

OUR ROTATION: SIX NAMES, FOUR STATIONS, FOUR JOBS



Test it before anybody stands on it. Both feet of the bench flat on the grass, the mat laid flush beside it with no gap, and a paw on the bench end pushing to see whether it rocks. Ten seconds. Do it every time the ground is rebuilt.

STAY SAFE

The meet uses more equipment, more space and more pupils moving at once than any single lesson in this unit, so the checks are stricter, not looser.

One adult walks the whole ground before it starts and after any station is rebuilt.

Stations do not overlap. No run up crosses another station's space. If two stations have to share a boundary, the cones marking it are the ones nobody crosses.

The word "stop" stops the whole meet, from anybody, including a mover.

□ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

Tick only what is true today. Come back at the end of the unit and tick again in a different colour.

- ☐ I can name the parts of a skill I already had, and its joins
- ☐ I can choose one part to change, and say it as something a body part does
- ☐ I can practise that part slowly on its own and then put it back
- ☐ I can join three skills with no stop at either join
- ☐ I can say which join is my weaker one and what happens there
- ☐ I can perform one skill at two different speeds on purpose
- ☐ I can perform one skill at two different levels on purpose
- ☐ I can perform one skill along two different paths on purpose
- ☐ I can keep moving when a Caller changes the rule
- ☐ I can make a good call myself: one thing, safe, three words
- ☐ I can watch somebody and say what I saw instead of whether it was good
- ☐ I can choose an activity for myself and give a reason for choosing it

How did it go?



Tuft, deciding. He has his own record sheet on his knee and a coloured pencil in his paw, and he has not marked it yet. He is looking back down the empty strip, remembering what his body actually did. That pause is the part of this page that matters.

Colour in one ring per row. Green if you could do it today, amber if you nearly could, and red if not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer in August.

WHAT YOU WERE WORKING ON	TODAY
Taking a skill apart into phases and joins	☐ ☐ ☐
Practising one part rather than repeating the whole thing	☐ ☐ ☐
Joining three skills with no stop	☐ ☐ ☐
Fixing a join by changing something earlier	☐ ☐ ☐
Turning the speed dial on purpose	☐ ☐ ☐
Turning the level dial on purpose	☐ ☐ ☐
Turning the path dial on purpose	☐ ☐ ☐
Adapting without stopping when a call came	☐ ☐ ☐
Watching well: what I saw, not whether it was good	☐ ☐ ☐
Being an honest timer	☐ ☐ ☐

Three questions to answer in a sentence each

- 1 Which one part of a skill did you change on this ground, and what told you it had changed?

ONE

- 2 Which of your joins is still your weakest, and what are you going to change before it?

TWO

- 3 Which of the four jobs are you worst at? Mover, timer, watcher or caller. Being worst at watcher is the most common answer and the most useful one to admit.

THREE

Words we used



Willow's notebook, open and waiting. A stopwatch, a pencil, an apple and one barn owl feather. Every word on the next two pages is a word she needed in order to write down what she saw.

Every word this ground taught you, with what it means here.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS ON THE FIELD
phase	One part of a movement, on its own. A throw has four.
join	The place where one phase becomes the next one. Where the work is.
phase strip	The drawing this book uses to show a movement's phases in order, with the joins as gaps.
repeat	Doing a movement again, with nothing you are trying to change.
practise	Doing a movement again <i>with one part you are trying to change</i> , a way to tell, and enough goes.
refine	To make one part of a skill better without changing the rest of it.
consolidate	To make a skill reliable, so it works when you are tired, rushed or watched.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS ON THE FIELD
sequence	Two or more skills performed one after another with no stop between them.
control	Your body does what you decided it would do.
fluency	It does it without stopping or wobbling.
variety	You can decide differently next time. Four settings, not one.
dial	Speed, level or path: the three things you can change about almost any movement.
level	How high your body is: high, medium or low, held for the whole distance.
path	The shape of the line you travel along: straight, curved or zigzag.
adapt	To change what your body is doing, while it is doing it, without stopping.
plan panel	The ground drawn from directly above.
elevation	The ground drawn from the side, which is the only way to show height.
mover	The job of doing the movement properly.
timer	The job of counting or timing, and saying the number that is really there.
watcher	The job of looking at one part and saying what you saw.
caller	The job of changing one thing, out loud, once, while the activity runs.

Answers for Unit 1



Willow reads her notes back. Five friends listening and nobody moving. This is what the rest of this section is for: not marks out of ten, but somebody saying exactly what they saw so the mover knows what to change.

Most of the work on the Practice Strip happens in a body rather than on a page, so most of these are **acceptance criteria** rather than single answers: what a correct response has to contain, whatever words a pupil uses. Where there is one right answer, it is given.

Topic 1.1 • Practise that changes a skill



Phase 2, done right. The elbow is above the shoulder, the other arm is pointing at the target, and the head is up. This is the position Tuft held six times before he threw at all. Compare it with what your watcher wrote.

TASK

The phase strip: how many phases and how many joins in an overarm throw?

ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS

Four phases (stand, reach, release, finish) and **three joins**. A movement always has one fewer join than it has phases.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
1. The one part I am changing	Names one phase or one join, and describes it as something a body part does. Accept "elbow above my shoulder before release". Do not accept "throw better", "be more accurate" or "concentrate", none of which a watcher can see.
2. The tally	Two rows filled in, with the "after" round done on the same day as the "before" round. A pupil whose second tally is worse has still completed the task correctly.
4. What changed, and how I know	Must contain evidence : a number, or something the watcher said. "It felt better" is not yet an answer; ask what the watcher saw.
5. Did the whole throw change?	Either answer is correct. A pupil who reports "my elbow got better and the ball still arrives low" has done the task properly and has found something genuinely worth discussing.
Why was Willow right that thirty throws was "one throw, thirty times"?	Because nothing was being changed between attempts, so no phase and no join received any attention. Repeating is not practising.

Topic 1.2 • Joining skills into a sequence



The join, close up. Both feet together and flat, knees deeply bent, tail out for balance. A landing that looks like this can become a balance without a second foot going down. That is the whole of join 2 into 3.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
What is a sequence judged on?	The joins , not the skills.
Bramble's sequence: where are the two joins?	Run into jump, and jump into balance.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
Why did taking two strides off the run up fix the last join?	He arrived at the landing travelling more slowly, so he no longer needed a second foot down to stop. A join is usually fixed earlier than the place where it goes wrong.
1. My sequence	Three named parts in a fixed order, and both joins named.
2 and 4. The two timing tables	Three attempts in each, timed, with stops counted by the watcher rather than by the mover. Improvement is not required; a filled table with honest numbers is a complete answer.
3. What happens at my worse join	Describes body movement: an extra step, a foot put down, a turn of the shoulders, a stop to look. Not "I mess it up".
5. The plan drawing	Contains all five marks: start ring, dashed route, crosses for equipment, and an arrow showing the facing at the end. The arrow is the one most pupils leave out.
Field challenge	Four parts, three joins, two seconds faster than their best three part time, zero stops. Making one part smaller in order to achieve it is expected and should be praised, not treated as a compromise.

Topic 1.3 • Control, fluency and variety



One hare, two levels. Same animal, same vest, same distance to cover. On the left she is upright and fast. On the right she is low and slow. If your four versions do not look at least this different from one another, the dial has not been turned far enough.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
Name the three dials.	Speed, level and path.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
What do control, fluency and variety each mean?	Control: the body does what the pupil decided. Fluency: it does it without stopping or wobbling. Variety: the pupil can decide differently next time.
Why did telling Sorrel to go slower not work, and why did the cones work?	Being told to change a dial does not give the body a reason to change it. The cone rule made low and slow the only way to complete the task , so the setting appeared without being mentioned.
2. The four timings	Four rows, four different dial settings, one observation each from the watcher.
3. The four plan drawings	Same skill in all four boxes. If the skill changes between boxes the task has been misunderstood: only the dial changes.
4. Hardest version	Almost always slow or low , and either is a good answer if a reason is given. Fast is rarely hardest, and a pupil who notices that has understood the topic.
5. When is each version the right choice?	Four plausible moments from a real activity. Accept anything specific: "low when somebody is trying to reach the ball over me", "curved to get round a defender", "slow to arrive at the same time as a pass".
Twelve metres is about what fraction of a lap?	About one thirty third . 400 divided by 12 is 33.3.

Topic 1.4 • Reading the field and the friends on it



Watch the hips. Sorrel's head still faces forward, but her hips have already turned. Tuft is low, balanced, and looking at the right part of her. Feet and eyes can both mislead you; hips cannot.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A CORRECT ANSWER CONTAINS
Of the five responses in the scenario, which is the skill being taught?	Tuft , who changed without stopping. Not Sorrel, who scored: she carried on playing the old game. Pip did not hear, and Bramble stopped in order to think.
What are the three things a Caller can change?	The rule , the space , or the people . One at a time.
What is the fourth thing that changes with nobody calling it?	What the person opposite you decides to do.
Where should you look, and why?	At the hips . Feet and eyes can both mislead; hips cannot lie about which way somebody is about to travel.
What did Tuft actually do, in order?	Finished the stride he was already in; turned his shoulders square to his direction of travel; took the next step sideways slowly, and only speeded up after the second sideways step landed.
2. The call table	Three calls recorded. Comparing the Caller's record with everybody else's memory is part of the task: disagreement is a result, not a mistake.
3. My call, and whether it was good	A good call changes one thing, is safe, and can be understood in three words. A pupil who judges their own call as poor and says why has answered better than one who says it was fine.
4. Choosing your own activity	Requires a reason linked to this unit: a dial setting it demands, or a job the pupil is weak at. "Because I like it" is not yet a justification; ask which dial it needs.
5. What I am going to copy	Names a pupil and describes an action, not a quality. "Copy Tuft turning his shoulders first" is right. "Tuft is good at games" is not.
Field challenge, the silent call	Nobody is told what changed. Success is the group working it out and carrying on. Twenty seconds of confusion is expected and is the point.

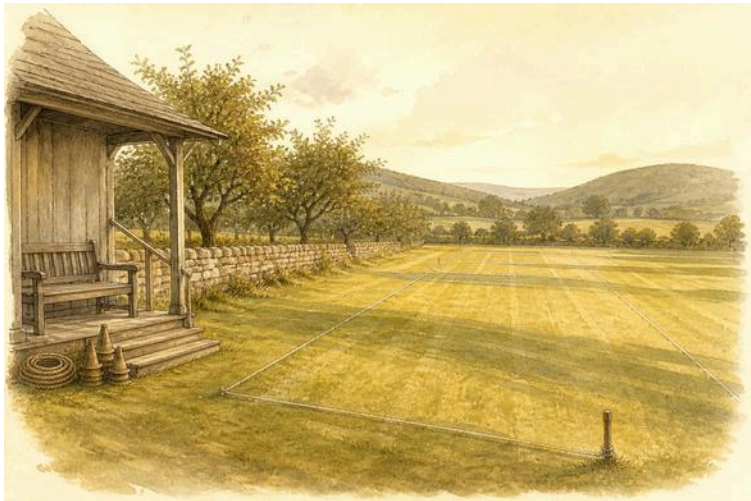
The long field games



The handover. Bramble passing the stopwatch to Rowan, both of them watching it change hands. There is no mark for this in any answer key, and it is the part of the afternoon the whole project is built around: everybody holds every job.

There is no answer key for the meet, and no winner. It is complete when every pupil has held all four jobs, every mover has a record sheet filled in **by their watcher**, and every pupil has written one sentence saying what changed and how they know.

Sources for Unit 1



Everything put away, and the light going. One bench against the pavilion, a coiled rope, a stack of cones and one peg still in the ground. Field rule 7 says put the equipment back without being asked, and this is what that looks like when everybody has.

Every fact and every square code destination in this unit, with the date it was checked. The full check record, including the sources that were considered and rejected, is in this book's 05-SOURCES-01.md.

Facts

PRINTED IN	CLAIM	SOURCE	CHECKED
Topic 1.1	Children and young people aged 5 to 18 should aim for an average of at least 60 minutes of moderate or vigorous intensity physical activity a day across the week, and a variety of types and intensities across the week to develop movement skills, muscles and bones	NHS, <i>Physical activity guidelines for children and young people</i> , nhs.uk	2026-08-11
Topic 1.3	The 400 metres is an event in which athletes complete one lap of a standard outdoor 400 m athletics track while running in a designated lane	World Athletics, discipline page for the 400 metres, worldathletics.org	2026-08-11

The fraction in the second panel, twelve metres as about one thirty third of a lap, was checked by calculation.

Square codes

PRINTED IN	WHERE IT GOES	WHAT IT IS FOR	CHECKED
Topic 1.2	youthsporttrust.org, free resources	60 second challenges, repeated and measured against a pupil's own last attempt	2026-08-11
Topic 1.4	nhs.uk, Healthier Families activities	An A to Z of sports and activities to choose your own from, and games you can vary	2026-08-12

Both destinations were open, free and required no login when this edition went to press. **An adult holds the device and opens the page.** Neither task needs a device in order to be finished.

Illustrations

All twenty-three illustrations in this book are original, produced for Prime School. The Prime School device is composited from the original artwork and was never redrawn.

Curriculum

The unit is mapped to the school's own scheme of work for Year 5 Physical Education, objectives 1.1 to 1.4. The mapping is printed in **For teachers** on the next page.

For teachers

What this edition contains

This is **Unit 1 of six**, built as a review sample. Units 2 to 6 are mapped in 06-SCHEME-MAP.md and are not written. The complete book is planned at 120 to 130 pages (DEC-034). Do not treat this build as a finished title.

Curriculum mapping

Four objectives, one topic each, taken from the school's scheme of work for Year 5 Physical Education.

TOPIC	SCHEME OBJECTIVE
1.1 Practise that changes a skill	1.1 Practise, refine and consolidate a broad range of movement skills
1.2 Joining skills into a sequence	1.2 Perform and be able to link together a wider variety of movement skills in short sequences

TOPIC	SCHEME OBJECTIVE
1.3 Control, fluency and variety	1.3 Display movement skills that demonstrate increasing control, fluency and variety
1.4 Reading the field and the friends on it	1.4 Apply movement competence with confidence in a variety of self-selected and more structured physical activities, showing the ability to respond and adapt to changing contexts and to others' movements, responses and roles

The scheme allocates 89 minutes to each objective. Every topic here is built to be delivered across two lessons rather than one, with the second lesson beginning at **Your turn**.

The assumptions this unit makes

- **A pupil cannot practise a whole skill.** Every task therefore asks for one phase or one join, chosen and named before anybody moves. If a class is choosing targets like "throw better", the unit has not started yet.
- **The joins carry the objective.** Objective 1.2 is assessed on the joins and not on the quality of the individual skills, which is why the watcher counts stops rather than awarding marks.
- **Variety is the weak point at this age**, not control. Most Year 5 classes contain several pupils with exactly one setting on every dial. Topic 1.3 exists for them, and the cone method in **Try it the other way** is the reliable route in.
- **The Caller is not a game manager.** It is an assessment role. Objective 1.4 asks for adaptation to changing contexts, and a Caller is how that context changes on purpose, in front of you, so you can see who adapts and who stops.

Assessment without a written test

The scheme lists a test in each of the three terms. This unit offers three pieces of evidence that do not need one:

- 1 **The tally tables** in 1.1 and the timing tables in 1.2 and 1.3, which are a pupil measured against their own earlier attempt.
- 2 **Look what I can do**, twelve statements ticked twice in different colours, at the start and the end of the unit.
- 3 **The long field games record sheets**, filled in by watchers rather than by movers.

Nothing in this unit ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body in order to succeed. Distances, heights and timings are adapted freely: the objective is control, not size or speed.

Safety

Every **Stay safe** panel is an instruction rather than advice, and the panels are the only magenta furniture in the book so that they cannot be mistaken for teaching. The unit assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and all apparatus set out and tested by an adult. Topic 1.2 involves a bench, mats and possibly a roll, and asks for adult supervision of every attempt. The track meet runs four stations at once and asks for the whole ground to be walked before it starts.

The three calls a Caller may never make are named on the page: nothing that stops a pupil seeing where they are going, nothing changed twice at once, and nothing called quietly.

What a teacher will want to change

- **Class size.** The unit is written for fours, and for a group of five or six at topic 1.4. With a class of thirty that is seven or eight simultaneous stations, which is more than most halls hold. Running 1.1 and 1.3 as a two station rotation works and is how the timings above were estimated.
- **The wall in 1.1.** If there is no wall that may be thrown at, a partner catching at eight metres works, but the watcher then has two things to look at instead of one. Prefer a wall.
- **The bench in 1.2.** A line on the floor works for pupils who are not ready for the bench, and the objective is unaffected: the joins are still the assessment.

Planning towards the three term days

Each term ends with a whole day on the field, and those days are printed for pupils on **Your year on the long field** in the front matter. For planning, here is the same mapping the other way round.

TERM DAY	HAVE THESE FINISHED FIRST	WHAT THE DAY ADDS
Athletics Day, term 1	1.1 and 1.2 for the standing long jump and the target throw; 1.3 for the obstacle race	Measured distances, and one recorder per station
Football Day, term 2	1.3 for the cone dribble; 1.4 for the full game	A caller for the small-sided games

TERM DAY	HAVE THESE FINISHED FIRST	WHAT THE DAY ADDS
Multi-sports Day , term 3	1.1 again on an unfamiliar skill; 1.3 for sack racing	A rotation, and a timekeeper who is not the mover

This unit deliberately teaches none of the sports on those days. It teaches the habit all three of them reward: choose one part, change it on purpose, and check with a watcher whether the whole thing got better. A class that has done Unit 1 properly arrives at Athletics Day already knowing how to practise, which is worth more on the day than knowing the rules of any single event.

Open questions on this title, for a project manager

- 1 The Physical Education cast changes register at Year 5. Years 1 to 4 carry six animal friends in watercolour; the approved Year 5, Year 6 and Year 7 covers are flat architectural illustrations with no animal on them. This title follows its own cover (DEC-033) with six named pupils. That is a collection-level decision.
- 2 Unit 4 and Unit 6 each carry six scheme objectives, which will not fit one Year 5 unit at 14 pt with real write-on space. Splitting or folding changes the unit count, the contents and the spine width.
- 3 Interior stock: this title prints white, per 03-MEMORY.md. Year 5 and Year 6 Art & Design print cream.

Detail for all three is in 01-DESIGN.md section 12.

What comes next on the long field

You have finished the Practice Strip. Before you close the book, one last thing, because it is the thing that carries over.

You did not learn a sport this term. You learned a habit: take a movement apart, choose one part, change it on purpose, and ask somebody who was watching whether the whole thing got better. That habit works on a throw, on a sequence, on a game, and on every one of the five places still waiting on this field.

Here is where it goes next.

NEXT	WHAT IT WILL ASK OF YOU
The Pavilion Steps	You have been the watcher. Now you learn the words for it, so that "he stopped" becomes "he put a second foot down because he was still travelling forwards".
The Orchard	Long grass, no rope, no lines at all. Movement nobody has shown you, and movement that says something.
The Match Ground	Rope and teams. Your job, everybody else's job, and your turn at deciding.
The Equipment Barn	Sharing one set of equipment safely, fair play, and how to ask for help well.
The Beacon Path	The long climb. What is happening inside you while you move, and what a working body needs.

Until then, the four jobs go with you. **Mover, timer, watcher, caller.** You can do all four now, and the one you are worst at is the one worth taking next.



Going home. Nobody won anything today. Every one of them can do something they could not do this morning, and can say what it was.



The long field, put away and waiting. Unit 1 is finished. The Pavilion Steps, the Orchard, the Match Ground, the Equipment Barn and the Beacon Path are still out there.